

Stop at a stable position

Thinking And Training

THE IDEA

Calculation should reach a point where the immediate forcing moves have settled enough for evaluation. Stopping after winning a queen is premature if your king is mated next. Stopping after a sacrifice is equally misleading if the forced recovery has not occurred.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A sequence wins a rook but leaves your queen attacked with check. Continue through that check and any forced recapture before counting the gain. The first visually satisfying moment is not necessarily the endpoint.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What makes an endpoint reasonably stable?

ANSWER AND REASONING

There is no unresolved check, obvious forced capture, or immediate decisive threat that changes the assessment. Quiet positions can still require deeper calculation, but tactical noise must first be resolved.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Evaluate after the forcing dust settles.